CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS

# Phishing Awareness Training

Spot it. Stop it. Report it.

CodeAlpha Cybersecurity Internship · Task 2 · Farhan Shaikh

# What is phishing?

A cyber attack where criminals pose as a trusted person or brand to trick you into sharing passwords, OTPs, card details, or installing malware.

### Email phishing

Mass emails pretending to be banks, delivery or IT teams.

### Spear phishing

Targeted messages using your name, role or colleagues.

### Smishing & vishing

Fake SMS, WhatsApp or phone calls asking for urgent action.

# Recognizing phishing emails

### Urgent tone

“Account locked! Act within 1 hour.”

### Odd sender

support@paypa1-secure.com instead of paypal.com

### Generic greeting

“Dear Customer” instead of your name

### Risky attachment

Unexpected .zip, .exe, .html or macro files

### Hidden links

Hover: the real URL differs from the text

### Asks for secrets

Passwords, OTP or card details by email

# Spotting fake websites

| Check | Legitimate | Fake |
|---|---|---|
| Domain | www.amazon.in | amazon-login.verify-id.xyz |
| Spelling | amazon.com | arnazon.com (r + n) |
| Padlock | HTTPS + correct domain | HTTPS alone proves nothing |
| Login page | Asks only for login | Also asks for card, OTP, PIN |

Tip: type the address yourself or use a saved bookmark.

# Social engineering tactics

### Urgency
“Pay now or your account is closed.”

### Authority
Fake CEO, bank officer or police.

### Fear
“Suspicious login detected on your account.”

### Greed
“You won a prize / refund waiting.”

### Trust
Impersonating a colleague or friend.

### Curiosity
“See who viewed your profile.”

# Real-world examples

### RSA, 2011

Phishing email with an Excel attachment titled “Recruitment plan” compromised employees and led to a breach of SecurID data.

### Twitter, 2020

Phone spear phishing of staff gave attackers internal tool access and control of high-profile accounts.

### Google & Facebook

Fake vendor invoices from a fraudster cost both companies over $100 million before being detected.

# Best practices

## Do

- Verify the sender and hover over links
- Enable multi-factor authentication
- Use a password manager
- Keep OS and browser updated
- Report suspicious mail to IT

## If you clicked

- Disconnect from the network
- Change the affected passwords
- Tell IT or your bank immediately
- Run a malware scan
- Watch accounts for odd activity

# Quick quiz

**1. Email from support@arnazon.com says your account locks in 1 hour. Phishing?**

Answer: Yes: lookalike domain plus urgency.

**2. A padlock in the browser means the site is safe.**

Answer: False: phishing sites can use HTTPS too.

**3. The “CEO” emails asking you to buy gift cards urgently. What now?**

Answer: Verify via another channel and report it.